

VOSTOK 1

Manned spacecraft

Vostok 1 was the first craft to carry a human being – Russian cosmonaut Yuri Gagarin – into space. On 12 April 1961, Gagarin spent over an hour orbiting Earth. He landed by parachute in the Saratov region of Russia, 280 km (174 miles) from the intended site at Baikonur – from where Vostok 1 had been launched.



Yuri Gagarin

The entire flight was controlled from the **Russian space centre** on Earth.

Spherical tanks held oxygen and nitrogen for life support

DATA FILE



SIZE: 2.3 m (7.5 ft) in diameter



DATE OF LAUNCH: 12 April 1961



MISSION DURATION: 1 hour, 48 minutes



SPACE AGENCY: Russian space program